



Welcome to the OSGeo:UK Newsletter

Hello and welcome to the new OSGeo:UK newsletter. This newsletter exists to share updates and information every couple of months about the OSGeo:UK local chapter, the OSGeo global organisation and general FOSS for geospatial goodness. Please share the newsletter with anyone you think might be interested - they can [sign up](#) too.

As we become more established, we'll be looking at ways that you can submit your own news and stories for inclusion in the newsletter, for circulation to a wide variety of recipients. For now, please enjoy this edition.

News from OSGeo:UK

Find out more about OSGeo:UK and how you can be part of our community on our [website](#).



On Tuesday 30th July 2024, there will be a UK code sprint on the south coast - [Code by the Coast](#). This is to be held at the The Heights Hotel, Portland, Dorset, UK and is a great opportunity to become involved in the free and open source community by helping to develop some up and coming open-source projects. Come along and meet up with other open-source developers here in the UK!

And don't be concerned if you are not a fully fledged developer - there are always lots of tasks to be done that require a range of skills. As it states on the event page: *"whether you are new to open-source geospatial development or have been working in the industry for years we hope this event will be the summer work-cation you need!"*.

OSGeo:UK are helping to fund the event, which is provided free of charge (with refreshments included). Spaces are limited though, so [book your tickets now](#) and maybe consider buying a "sponsored place" ticket (you pay for the full cost of your ticket to help ensure there are free places available for those that can't).

On the subject of events, we circulated a Call for Venues and Volunteers earlier this year for what will hopefully be the next FOSS4G:UK. We had a couple of responses for venues (both in Scotland) and sadly only one volunteer to help run an event. We really need your thoughts and inputs here - we know that there is a high level of interest in another FOSS4G:UK event, but we need community input to help make it a great event. If you know of a suitable venue, or if you want to join a dedicated group of volunteers then let us know via one of the contact methods listed on the [OSGeo:UK website](#) or by getting in touch with one of the committee. Due to the low number of responses, there will not be a national event (local or single venue) this year but we are planning to have an event in 2025 so please do come forward with ideas.

There has also been some talk about applying to host a global conference in the UK, which would be a substantial but rewarding undertaking and would need a separate volunteer organising committee. If you would like to be involved, then please get in touch by emailing osgeouk@gmail.com.

We are also very happy to support individual events, so if you wish to organise one of these, please do. We are willing to help out where we can - please reach out and let us know if you would like some help.

Projects sponsored by OSGeo:UK

Did you know that OSGeo:UK supports the open source community in multiple different ways? One such way is through financial sponsorship of suitable projects, and we tend to do this annually through our [GoFundGeo](#) mechanism. For the period between the 2023 and 2024 AGMs it has been agreed to distribute more than five and a half thousand pounds across the following seven projects:

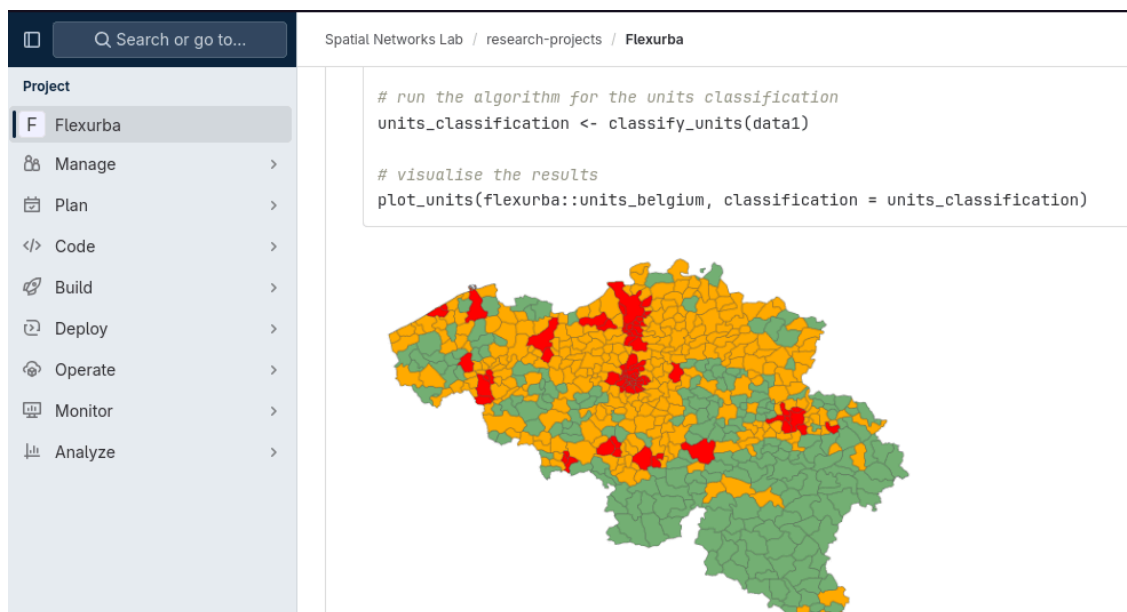
- [pgRouting Gold Sponsorship](#), \$1200 (£963) per year
- [QGIS Sustaining Membership small level](#), €1,000 (£870) per year
- [James Milner, development of Terra Draw](#), up to £1,000
- North Road/Nyall Dawson: QGIS layout background formatting, £1,000
- [GISRUK GoFundGeo](#): £200
- Dorset Code Sprint: £600
- [qgis2web](#): Supporting Andrea Ordonselli to take on and develop gis2web, £1,000

Further, we are also an [OSGeo Silver Sponsor](#).

The great thing about this sort of support is that you can easily see the help it delivers. In the last few months qgis2web has developed two point releases moving from 3.17.1 in December to 3.19 in March.

The TerraDraw project is also under continual development and you can hear more about it on [episode 226](#) of the [Geomob podcast](#).

Hot off the press is the news that Flexurba are the first ever winners of the GISRUK / OSGeo:UK GoFundGeo award. All of the [details are on our website](#) (including links to the code and documentation) but Flexurba is a library written in R with the first open reconstruction of the Degree of Urbanisation algorithm to classify cities, towns, and rural areas. Go check it out!



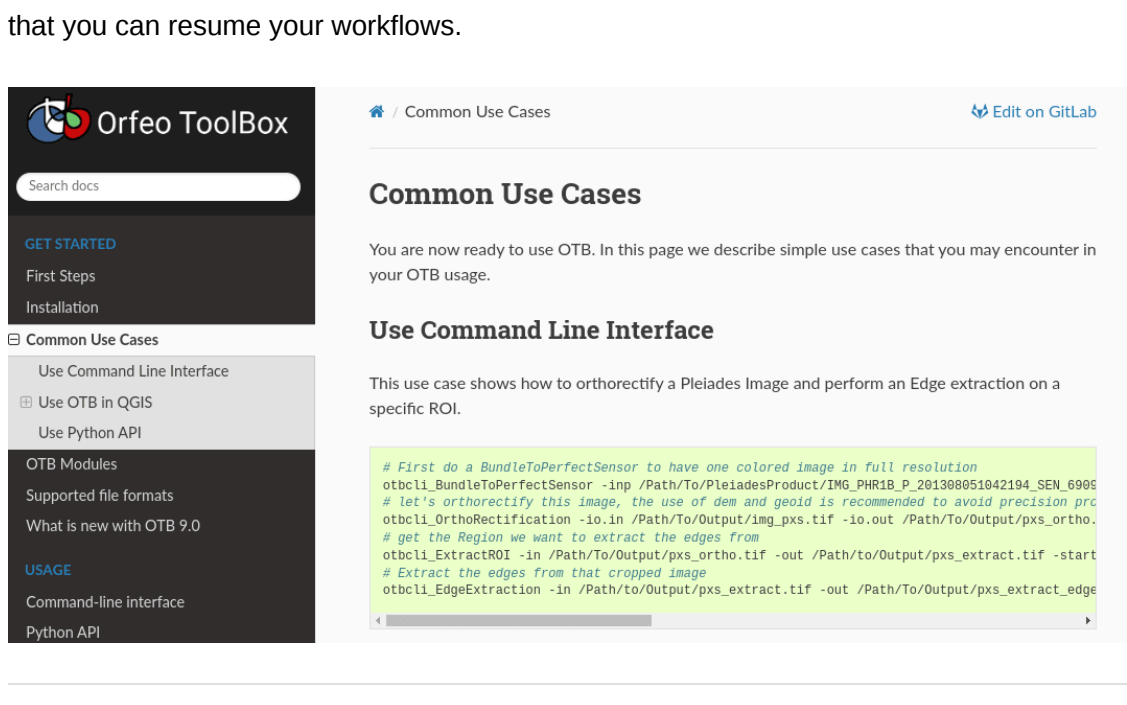
Wider software and event news

[FOSS4G Europe 2024](#) is less than 3 months away! Between 1-7 July 2024 the city of [Tartu](#) in Estonia is hosting the latest incarnation of this flagship European event. If you want to meet the European open source geospatial community and find out what is happening across various projects then book your place at the conference - early-bird tickets remain available until the 10th May. The [schedule](#) has now been released, and there is also a [Telegram channel](#) for live discussions with the organisers and participants.

The [global FOSS4G 2024](#) event (December 1-8, 2024) is being held in Brazil for the first time! The host city is [Belém](#), in the state of Pará, located in the heart of the Amazon! Every FOSS4G is special but this is an amazing opportunity to visit the gateway to the Amazon. A dedicated local organising committee looks forward to welcoming you to their city and nation, and an event that will showcase open software and data, and open communities from around the world. This should be incredible!

Development Seed have recently released [Lonboard](#), a Python library designed to provide fast, interactive geospatial vector data visualisation in [Jupyter](#) notebooks. It takes existing cutting-edge technologies, like GeoArrow and GeoParquet and builds on these using GPU map rendering to enable visualising of large geospatial datasets interactively. It would be interesting to hear from you if you have tried Lonboard to know what you think, and to understand how it compares to other visualisation libraries such as [Datashader](#).

If you are a user of the Orfeo Toolbox via QGIS then you are probably aware that since the release of QGIS 3.36 Maidenhead (named by the [OSGeo:UK community](#)!) then [native support has been removed](#). However, you may be less aware that integration with OTB tools can now be restored by installing the dedicated plugin from the Plugin catalogue. All of the details are available in the docs, including how to [install and configure the plugin](#) so that you can resume your workflows.



We hope that you found this edition of the newsletter interesting and informative. If you have any feedback or comments then let us know!



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